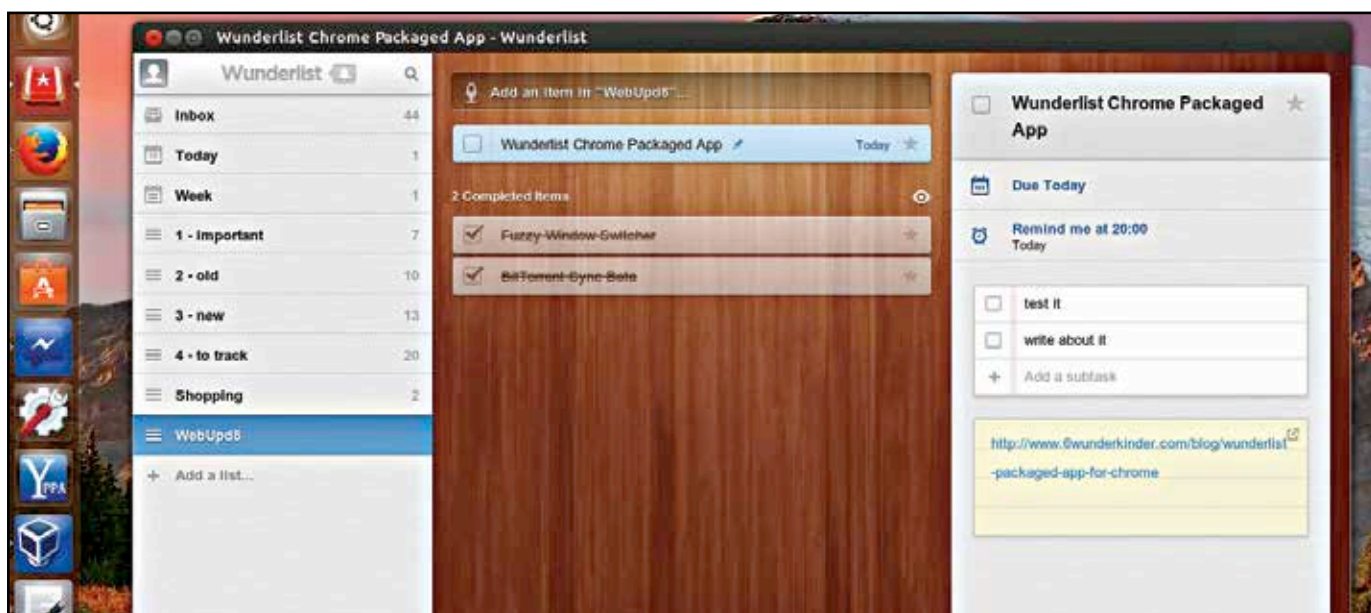




Build an installable Chrome Packaged App

>>A quick guide on programming the address bar of Chrome using JavaScript> By Ashesh Lal



Wunderlist is an excellent example of a popular Chrome packaged app.

To address the ongoing need for cross-platform applications, Google is attempting to emulate smartphone apps to build more user friendly web applications running directly from a browser. An application running inside a browser typically has its own dedicated UI coupled with rich user interaction. These could include games, photo editors or even video players that run inside the browser. 'Chrome Packaged Apps' or 'Chrome Apps' are installable web apps that are available for download on the Chrome Web Store and behave like a fusion of extensions and hosted apps. Packaged Apps don't share the Chrome interface (unlike extensions) and allow hardware devices, such as your camera, to be utilised over TCP/IP (Network), USB and Bluetooth by giving additional privileges to the application, making web apps behave like desktop apps. The capabilities of Chrome apps include desktop

notifications – hard to imagine with a browser as the platform even just a few years ago.

Without diving into any more detail, let's get into the essence of this article and make our first packaged app for Google Chrome. The app will show programmability of the Omnibox – Chrome's address bar. It will also demonstrate how the Omnibox uses keywords such as "wiki" and "facebook" to allow access to the search engines of these respective sites and provide suggestions to the user.

What you will need:

1. An active internet connection;
2. Text editor: Sublime Text 2 with Chrome Apps plug-in;
3. Basic JavaScript knowledge;
4. \$5 or ₹310;